The Ultimate Pregnancy *Diet Plan*

Including 5 Must Eat Foods PLUS 5 Foods To Avoid To Keep Your Tiny Bub Safe!



Welcome

to my delicious and nutritious 7-day meal plan for expectant mothers!

As an Accredited Practising Dietitian and mum of three who specialises in pregnancy nutrition, I love helping mums-to-be with their eating before, during and after pregnancy.

I know firsthand how challenging it can be to eat well while dealing with morning sickness, food aversions and cravings that seem to come out of nowhere.

But fear not, because with this meal plan you'll have plenty of tasty and satisfying options to keep you and your growing baby nourished and energised. So put on your favourite maternity leggings, grab a fork, and let's dig in!



Foods to Avoid During Pregnancy:

Before we begin, let's talk about which foods you should avoid to keep your tiny bubba safe...

Pregnancy changes your immune system, making you more susceptible to foodborne illnesses such as listeriosis, salmonellosis and toxoplasmosis, which can cause serious problems for you and your baby. So it's important to avoid foods with a higher risk of carrying harmful bacteria or parasites. This advice follows Food Standards Australia New Zealand.

1. **Deli Meats and Undercooked Meat** - Sliced cold meats, pâté and raw or undercooked meat, chicken or fish can carry listeria or salmonella. Eat meat freshly cooked and steaming hot.
2. **Soft Cheeses and Unpasteurised Dairy** - Brie, camembert, ricotta, feta, blue cheese and unpasteurised milk can carry listeria. Hard cheeses and pasteurised milk and yoghurt are fine.
3. **Raw or Runny Eggs** - Raw or undercooked eggs, including homemade mayonnaise and aioli, can carry salmonella. Cook eggs until firm.
4. **Raw Seafood and High-Mercury Fish** - Avoid sushi, raw oysters and cold smoked salmon. Limit shark (flake), swordfish, marlin, orange roughy and catfish, which are high in mercury.
5. **Pre-Cut Salads and Fruit** - Pre-packed salads, salad bars and pre-cut fruit can carry listeria. Wash and cut your own.

Foods to Eat During Pregnancy:

Now, I think that's enough talking about what you shouldn't eat during pregnancy... now let's talk about what you should aim to include.

Pregnancy increases your body's need for nutrients such as folate, iodine, iron, calcium and protein, which are essential for your baby's growth and development.

Eating a balanced, nutrient-rich diet supports a healthy pregnancy and helps you feel your best. It can also help establish good eating habits that benefit both you and your baby in the long term.

1. **Dark Leafy Greens** - Spinach, kale and silverbeet are rich in folate, a B vitamin that helps form your baby's neural tube, the start of the brain and spine.
2. **Lean Protein Sources** - Lean meat, chicken, fish, eggs and legumes help grow and repair your baby's new tissues and make important hormones, enzymes and antibodies for their immune system.
3. **Wholegrains** - Wholemeal bread, rolled oats, brown rice and quinoa are rich in fibre, B vitamins and folate, and help keep constipation at bay.
4. **Dairy Foods** - Pasteurised milk, hard cheese and yoghurt are rich in calcium, which is important for your baby's bones and nervous system.
5. **Berries** - Strawberries, blueberries and raspberries are rich in antioxidants and vitamin C, which also helps your body absorb iron.



Quick Tips to Follow During Pregnancy:

Remember, it's not only about what you eat and don't eat during pregnancy. Here are some important tips to keep you feeling your best during your pregnancy journey:

1. Eat small, frequent meals throughout the day to help with nausea, dizziness and heartburn.
2. Drink plenty of fluids, mostly water and milk. Keep caffeine under 200 mg a day and avoid alcohol.
3. Limit foods and drinks that are high in added sugar, salt and saturated fat.
4. Take folic acid (400 micrograms) and iodine (150 micrograms) daily, plus anything else your doctor recommends.
5. Talk to your dietitian about any dietary restrictions or concerns you may have.

7-Day Meal Plan for Pregnant Women:

To help make things as simple as possible, I've put together an example 7-day meal plan that steers you clear of the foods to avoid and makes the most of the foods you want to prioritise!

Day 1:

Breakfast:
Porridge with berries and almonds

Snack:
Apple slices with peanut butter

Lunch:
Grilled chicken salad with mixed greens, carrot and cucumber

Snack:
Greek yoghurt with honey and granola

Dinner:
Baked salmon with roasted vegetables and brown rice

Day 2:

Breakfast:
Scrambled eggs (cooked firm) with wholemeal toast and avocado

Snack:
Carrot sticks with hummus

Lunch:
Wrap with freshly cooked chicken, cheddar, spinach and tomato

Snack:
Orange slices with almonds

Dinner:
Beef stir-fry with mixed vegetables and quinoa

Day 3:

Breakfast:
Greek yoghurt with mixed berries and granola

Snack:
Banana with almond butter

Lunch:
Lentil soup with wholegrain bread

Snack:
Cheese stick with apple slices

Dinner:
Grilled chicken with sweet potato wedges and green beans

Day 4:

Breakfast:
Smoothie with spinach, banana and milk

Snack:
Trail mix with dried fruit and nuts

Lunch:
Toasted cheese sandwich with tomato soup

Snack:
Cottage cheese with peach slices

Dinner:
Prawn and vegetable stir-fry with brown rice

Day 5:

Breakfast:
Wholemeal pancakes with blueberries and maple syrup

Snack:
Edamame

Lunch:
Quinoa salad with chickpeas, cherry tomatoes and cucumber

Snack:
Pear slices with almond butter

Dinner:
Baked chicken with roasted root vegetables and couscous

Day 6:

Breakfast:
Yoghurt parfait with granola and mixed berries

Snack:
Carrot sticks with tzatziki

Lunch:
Tuna salad sandwich with wholegrain bread and mixed greens

Snack:
Trail mix with dried fruit and nuts

Dinner:
Vegetable lasagne with a garden salad

Day 7:

Breakfast:
Wholegrain waffles with sliced banana and honey

Snack:
Homemade popcorn

Lunch:
Roasted vegetable wrap with hummus and mixed greens

Snack:
Mango slices with yoghurt

Dinner:
Beef and vegetable kebabs with quinoa and green beans



There you have it, a delicious and nutritious 7-day meal plan for expectant mothers!

Now remember, each person's nutritional needs are unique. This plan is a guide, so it's important to talk with an Accredited Practising Dietitian about a plan that meets your individual needs.

I'm here to support you on your journey to a healthy pregnancy. If you have any questions or would like to talk things through, book a free 15-minute call with me.

I look forward to hearing from you!

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